

The Money Story Method

The 5-phase system my clients used to go from \$10,000 in debt to \$10,000 in the bank, halve their debt, triple their savings, and finally pay themselves a steady wage.

A guide for self-employed people who earn good money, but still feel behind.

Joel Ezekiel

MSc Behavioural Economics | Qualified Financial Planner

Want 1-on-1 help putting everything in this guide into your own accounts?

>>> APPLY HERE <<<

An open letter from Joel

Please read this properly. Don't skim it. If you don't have half an hour right now, bookmark it and come back when you do.

First, who this is for.

- You earn good money, but it's **gone by the end of the month, with nothing to show for it.**
- Your income goes up and down, so you've **never paid yourself a steady wage.**
- You're always waiting for **the dip that's just round the corner.**
- You **avoid opening the banking app**, because you're scared of what you'll see.
- **Tax hangs over you** all year.
- You **know what to do. You just don't do it.**
- You've bought the books and the courses, and **nothing stuck.**
- You **undercharge**, discount, or say yes to cheap work, then wonder where the money went.
- You don't want to be rich. You want **calm, something to show for it, and more time with the people you love.**



Joel Ezekiel

And who this is NOT for.

- If you want Lamborghinis and mansions and holiday homes, this isn't for you.
- If you're looking for **your ticket out**, the next trade that takes you to the moon, this isn't for you. I've been there. It cost me £150k.
- If you just want more information, this isn't for you. You've got enough of that.

Why you should listen to me

I remember it like it was yesterday, honestly.

Between 2019 and 2020, I was teaching myself to trade. I remember dabbling in leverage every day, and it was just spiking anxiety all the time, all the time, all the time. I was constantly looking at the chart. Because it was just like, this is my ticket out. This is going to do so well.

And then my account just started to blow up. It was growing by ten grand every other day. It went from three grand, to ten k, all the way to one fifty k by mid-April, May.

I was like, oh my god, I'm going to the moon. I was getting all my friends involved.

And then, literally the day after everyone said this was just getting started, everything crashed. I told myself it's fine, it's fine, it's just a little bump. My one fifty k went down to a hundred k. Maybe eighty k.

Then it started going up again. And I was like, great, we're back on track.

And then as fast as I'd made the one fifty k, I lost it even faster.

I woke up the next morning. I meditated for twenty minutes, tried to calm my mind down. And I remember finishing meditating, looking at my phone, and seeing two messages.

The first one said: *your account has been liquidated.*

And my heart dropped.

The second one was from the girl I was seeing. Saying she couldn't do this anymore. And I was in love with that girl. Head over heels.

In that moment, I didn't just get punched in the face once. I got punched in the face twice.

And from that day, I said to myself: I will do whatever it takes to make sure this never happens again.

After that, I got my master's in behavioural economics. I became a financial planner. I lost a hundred and fifty thousand pounds of my own money, and I built it back up using these techniques. I've done it for myself. I've done it for others.

Looking back, I realise all the psychological biases that stopped me from pushing the sell button.

I'm here to bridge the gap between the cold, hard, boring traditional finance that we all love or hate, and the real work that has to be done. The real inner work that we need to do as individuals.

First, I need to make a point

Most people aren't really overspending. They're under-budgeting, and then they're calling this gap failure in their finances. Failure in themselves.

There is something called the knowing-doing gap. We know what to do. Or we know what to do, we've done all the research, but we still can't bring ourselves to doing it.

So we chase the next best thing. The next product that's supposed to solve everything. The next tool, the next course. And I'm guilty of this too.

And the fix isn't willpower. Let's say you always end up covering the bill on nights out. The fix is a separate account with a set amount in it, just for nights out, and a rule that once it's run out, it's run out for that month. It's done.

So this is the formula in a nutshell. **Awareness plus structure equals success.** That simple.

And earning more won't fix it. You're going to keep struggling with your finances no matter how much you earn, until you have a solid structure that decides exactly how much money goes where.

You've got to think of yourself as a business, right? Businesses budget. They have a forecast for the year.

So that's what the Money Story Method does. Awareness, then structure. Here's the proof, then here's how it works.

The proof

Josh was a chef carrying debt in rand and dollars. When we started, he was in the red.

*Me: "When we started this, you were negative \$10,000. You're now \$10,300 in the green." Josh: **"That's pretty accurate."***

His credit cards are basically all done, and more than half of every pay cheque now goes straight to what's left of his debt. Before, it was 5 to 15%.

Alex halved his debt, from £2,000 to £1,000, and covered his flatmate's rent for the first time ever.

"I've got 10 days to a payday and I've got 700 quid. I'm not afraid to check the balance anymore."

Lynton, a personal trainer, moved R200,000 into an account that pays him interest, automated R20,000 a month into savings, and now has more than six months of costs saved.

"I do believe you've taken me further than anyone else could have in this situation, because there's a programme to it."

Alon had about £2,000 in his account in May. By August, it was £6,000.

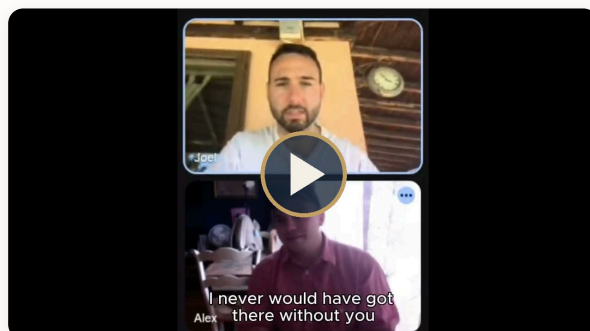
Hear it from them

Real clips from real coaching calls. Tap any one to watch.



"You've removed money from the pedestal for me... I am in control of it. It is not in control of me."

Josh • WATCH HERE



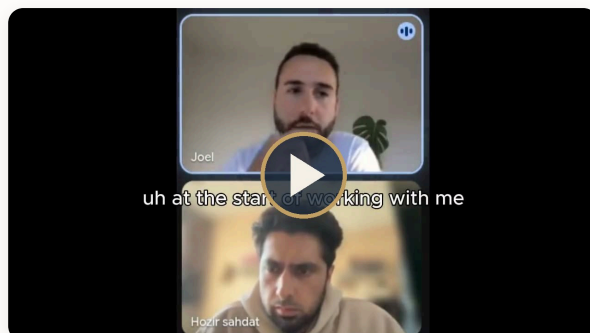
"I never would have got there without you. Never. I can 100% say that."

Alex • WATCH HERE



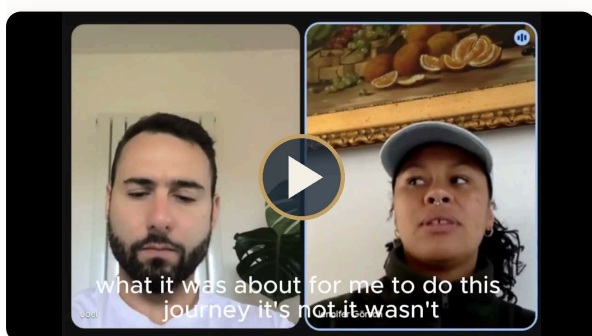
"I've cleaned up my spending, I've put my structured payments into place... I have a plan, I have a system, and that's been working."

Lynton • WATCH HERE



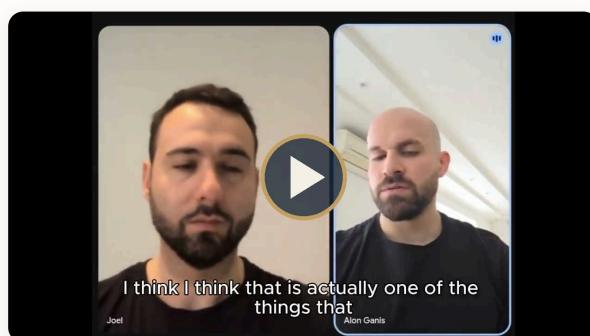
Anxiety around money at the start: "probably around nine, ten." Now: "maybe four or five."

Hozir • WATCH HERE



"It wasn't just about learning new money tools, but actually being taken by the hand, kind of guided through this process."

Jennifer • WATCH HERE



"When we actually looked over the numbers, it made everything clearer, and that fear really went away."

Alon • WATCH HERE

Every one of them already knew what to do. Here's what changed.

The 5 phases

Each phase has one job. Do them in order.

1. The 90-Day Money Audit
2. Money Moves
3. Your Money Story
4. Guardrails
5. Your Cash Flow Plan

Phase 1: The 90-Day Money Audit

The first thing we do, right out the gate, is the ninety-day audit. We audit the last ninety days of every account, every card, everything.

Why ninety and not thirty? Because one month is just noise. It misses the quarterly stuff. It could be a bad month. Three months is the shortest window that shows your actual pattern, rather than just a snapshot.

What you think you spend and what you spend are completely different numbers. I've seen this with every single client I've worked with. Not one has come back with an accurate reading on their numbers. And it's normal. We're human.

Put it into rough categories. Don't be a perfectionist, because perfection is procrastination.

You'll usually find two things. A category far bigger than you'd have guessed. And money going out for something you completely forgot about. Every single time.

Then we find your **real number**. Christmas isn't a surprise. Neither is your car service. Neither are holidays. Take everything that only shows up once a year, add it up, and divide it by 12. Now you have your real number. This is the one that stops the "where did that come from?" months.

OUTCOME FOR PHASE 1

- ☐ I know my real number
- ☐ I've found £200 a month

Phase 2: Money Moves

By week three, the money moves.

Money named "emergency fund" gets spent less than the same money sitting in a current account. It's not logic. It's just a bias doing its work for you. So we use it.

Separate accounts. Not folders in your head. Four pots:

1. Taxes (untouchable). Especially for self-employed people, money in this pot is not yours. It's not yours. I'll say it again. It is not yours.

How much? The share you choose. But here's the real maths, so you can choose well. Let's say £5,000 a month comes in, and your work costs £500. That's £54,000 of profit a year. In the UK, for 2026/27, the first £12,570 is tax-free, then it's 20% income tax up to £50,270 and 40% above that, plus 6% National Insurance (2% above £50,270). That comes to about £11,370 a year, or about £950 a month. That's about 19% of everything that comes in. So setting aside 20% covers it. Your accountant has the final word.

2. Business overheads. What your work costs to run, ring-fenced.

3. Your slow-month buffer. Plan on your worst three months. Take the average of your worst three months over the last two years. That's your floor. Instead of thinking you're going to keep earning and earning, now you have a baseline to protect at all costs.

4. What's yours to keep. A steady wage you pay yourself: what your life costs. The same in a big month or a quiet one.

This is exactly what my free Money Reset Tool does. Here it is with the numbers above.

STEP ONE

Your numbers.

£ \$ € C\$ R ₪

ROUGHLY WHAT HITS YOUR BUSINESS ACCOUNT EACH MONTH?

Everything that comes in from your work, before anything goes out.

£5,000 a month

1,000 10,000 20,000

ROUGHLY WHAT DOES YOUR WORK COST TO RUN EACH MONTH?

Software, equipment, insurance, travel, anything your work needs to run.

£250 £500 £750 £1,000 Custom

HOW MUCH DO YOU WANT TO SET ASIDE FOR TAXES?

Not sure? Pick one to see how the split works, then check your real figure with your accountant.

20% 25% 30%

ROUGHLY WHAT DOES YOUR LIFE COST EACH MONTH?

Rent or mortgage, food, bills, everything you need to live. Not your work costs.

£1,500 £2,000 £2,500 £3,000 Custom

Reset My Numbers →

GROSS IN

£5,000 a month

WHAT'S YOURS TO KEEP

£577 / week

(or £2,500 / month on the 1st)

What your life costs, paid to you like a salary. The same whether you had a big month or a quiet one.

🏛 Taxes (Untouchable) 20%

£1,000 /mo

Swept the day money lands, so the tax money is put aside before you can spend it.

📁 Business Overheads

£500 /mo

What your work costs to run, ring-fenced.

🛡 Slow-Month Buffer

£1,000 /mo

Builds up automatically during strong months to protect your paycheck when you take time off.

£5,000 comes in. £1,000 goes to tax. £500 runs the business. Your life costs £2,500, so that's your wage: £577 a week. Every week. And the £1,000 left over builds your buffer.

And if what's left doesn't cover your life? The tool tells you exactly how far short you are, and how much more needs to come in.

Then we set it up with standing orders, so it happens without you. If a client pays, then the tax share goes straight into tax that day.

OUTCOME FOR PHASE 2

- ☐ My four pots are open
- ☐ My standing orders are on
- ☐ My buffer has started

If you'd rather have me set this up with you, in your actual bank accounts:

>>> APPLY HERE <<<

Phase 3: Your Money Story

Why you'll actually do it this time.

This is the part most money advice skips.

A money script is a deep-seated belief about money that is usually formed in childhood and drives what you do with money.

Growing up, what did you see your parents or guardians do? How did they actually spend money? Did they spend it freely? Did they spend it with guilt, or did they spend it in secret? Did they argue? How did they argue?

Once you can start to see these things, you can start to piece together where your money story comes from, and how it shaped what you do today.

Then we find your core belief, test it, and rewrite it. And the rewrite has to be grounded in evidence. A bad rewrite is "money is safe." A good rewrite is "money is dangerous when I'm not looking at it."

This is why the money moves in Phase 2 actually stick. Without it, most people are back to square one within a few months.

OUTCOME FOR PHASE 3

- ☐ I know my money pattern
- ☐ I've rewritten one belief

Phase 4: Guardrails

A guardrail is built for the version of you who's stressed, not the one who's calm.

We create friction on the leak. Make the thing you overdo slightly harder. If you have a problem with Apple Pay, get rid of Apple Pay. Create friction on the things that make your money leak out. And automation on the wins. We take the decision away from us.

And we use something called an if-then plan. It's one sentence. If a client pays, then the tax share goes straight into tax that day. Not "I should save more for tax."

Why does it work? Because you're deciding now, calmly. When future you shows up, they're tired, they're hungry, they're stressed, they're bored. And the plan means there's nothing left to decide.

The test of a good guardrail is: does it work on your worst day? If it doesn't, you tweak it.

OUTCOME FOR PHASE 4

- ☐ My if-then plan is running
- ☐ My automation is checked

Phase 5: Your Cash Flow Plan

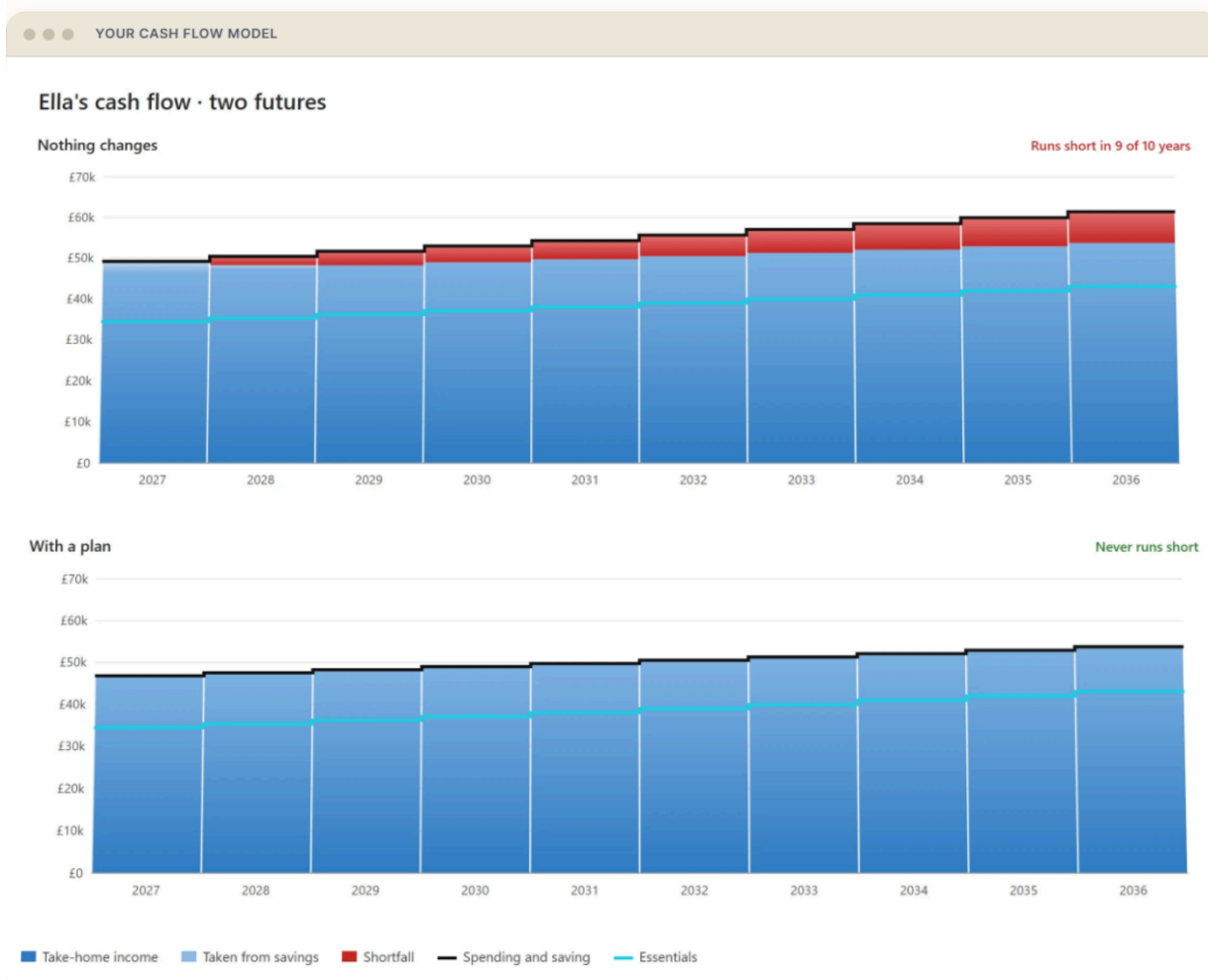
A cash flow model is your numbers projected forward, so you can see where your current pattern actually lands. Your future money stops being so abstract.

Every single client I've worked with, as soon as I've shown them the cash flow plan, it's like a light bulb goes off. They finally see all the work we've been doing together come together in one moment. It's exciting, it's comforting, it's shocking.

But the work beforehand, the belief work, has a massive power over the plan. I could show you a cash flow plan right out the gate. It's not going to have that much of an impact.

It's not a prediction. It's a picture of the path you're on, and what changes if we make one small decision together.

Here's what that looks like. Same income, two futures.



And here's part of the report you take away.

The turnover that pays for enough

YOUR NUMBER: TURNOVER NEEDED EACH YEAR

£56,677

That covers £3,450 a month take-home, the tax and National Insurance on your profit, and £400 a month of business costs.

PER MONTH

£4,723

spread over 12 months

PER WORKING WEEK

£1,232

46 working weeks

PER WORKING DAY

£308

4 days a week

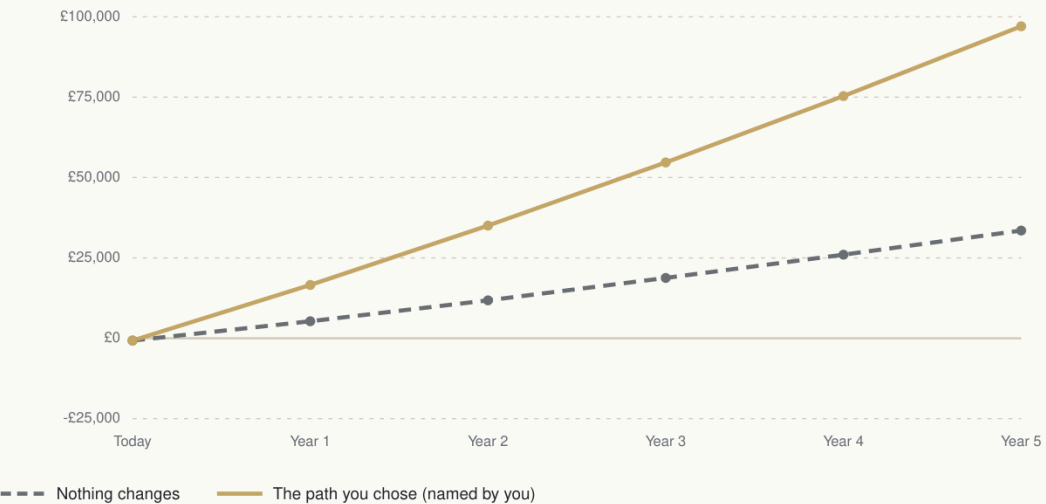
How it adds up

Enough each month	£3,000
Cash to put by each month	£300
Debt payments, as they are today	£150
Take-home needed each month	£3,450
Take-home needed a year	£41,400
Income tax to set aside (a year)	£8,183
National Insurance to set aside (a year)	£2,294
Profit needed (a year)	£51,877
Business costs (a year)	£4,800
Turnover needed (a year): your number	£56,677

Illustration, not a forecast. These figures are arithmetic on the numbers you gave today. Real life will not follow them exactly. Debt payments are held at today's amount. No repayment options are modelled.

Net worth over 5 years

Two lines on one scale, both from your full cash flow model. One where nothing changes, one with only the change described on the call. Net worth is everything you hold minus what you owe, the same measure as the next page.



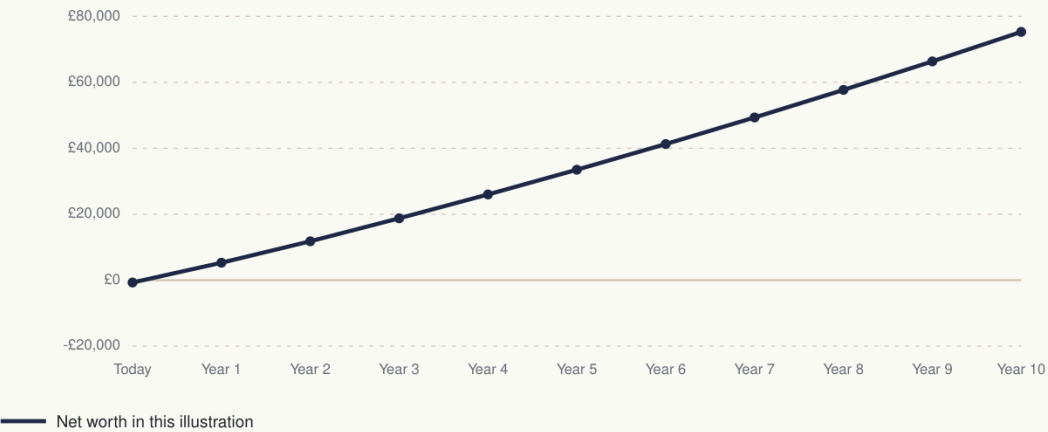
	NOTHING CHANGES	THE PATH
Takings a month	As in the model	£5,175
Business take-home a month	£2,790	£3,712
Net worth, Today	-£700	-£700
Net worth, Year 1	£5,309	£16,596
Net worth, Year 2	£11,805	£35,055
Net worth, Year 3	£18,775	£54,699
Net worth, Year 4	£26,011	£75,349
Net worth, Year 5	£33,516	£97,045

The path: £90 a session, 4 days a week, 5 sessions a day, 75% booked. That is £5,175 a month in takings. After £400 a month of business costs, income tax and self-employed National Insurance, that is £3,712 a month take-home. It replaces "Take-home from the practice (after tax)" (£2,790 a month) in your model. Everything else in the model stays as it is. Nothing changes: your full model as it is, the same figures as the next page.

Illustration, not a forecast. These figures are arithmetic on the numbers you gave today. Real life will not follow them exactly. Every assumption is listed at the end of this report.

Year by year

The full model from the call, carried forward 10 years. Net worth here is everything you hold minus what you owe.



Year 10 in this illustration: net worth £75,314.

YEAR	TAKE-HOME	COSTS	LEFT OVER	SHORT	SAVINGS	DEBT	NET WORTH
Today	£33,480	£27,000	£3,480	—	£2,500	£3,200	-£700
Year 1	£34,150	£27,675	£3,475	—	£7,323	£2,013	£5,309
Year 2	£34,833	£28,367	£3,466	—	£12,329	£525	£11,805
Year 3	£35,529	£29,076	£4,705	—	£18,775	£0	£18,775
Year 4	£36,240	£29,803	£5,237	—	£26,011	£0	£26,011
Year 5	£36,965	£30,548	£5,217	—	£33,516	£0	£33,516
Year 6	£37,704	£31,312	£5,192	—	£41,297	£0	£41,297
Year 7	£38,458	£32,095	£5,163	—	£49,360	£0	£49,360
Year 8	£39,227	£32,897	£5,130	—	£57,713	£0	£57,713
Year 9	£40,012	£33,719	£5,092	—	£66,362	£0	£66,362
Year 10	£40,812	£34,562	£5,050	—	£75,314	£0	£75,314

Illustration, not a forecast. Real life will not follow these figures exactly. Every assumption is listed at the end of this report.

OUTCOME FOR PHASE 5

- ☐ My plan is built
- ☐ I've chosen my path

Not ready for coaching? Book a Cash Flow Session instead, and get clarity on your number, and your future number, for the first time ever. 75 minutes, live on screen.

>>> BOOK YOUR CASH FLOW SESSION <<<

Still not sure? Meet Priya and Tom.

Meet Priya

38

Counsellor in private practice

About £4,000 a month comes in

Hasn't raised her prices in three years

Opens her banking app with one eye shut

Priya's good at her job. Clients love her. But some months are full and some are quiet, and every month she's not sure what's actually hers. So she doesn't pay herself. She just spends from the business account and hopes.

Every January, the tax bill lands, and it's a shock. Every single year.

Now, let's say Priya does Phase 1 and Phase 2. Her work costs £300 a month. She sets aside 20% for tax: £800 a month. Her real UK tax and National Insurance on that income comes to about £690 a month, so she's covered, with room to spare.

That leaves her £2,900. Her life costs about £2,200 a month, so she pays herself £2,200. That's £508 a week. Every week. Quiet month or busy month. And the £700 left over builds her slow-month buffer.

January comes. The tax money is already sitting there. She pays it and gets on with her day.

That's it. That's the whole change. Nothing about Priya got cleverer. She just stopped deciding in the moment.

Meet Tom

45

Plasterer

Flat out in summer, dead in winter

Earns well, still feels skint by February

"I'll sort it next year"

Tom's made about £45,000 profit this year. He's never once put money aside for tax. So in January, he's hit with a bill of around £8,400 in tax and National Insurance, and he's not got it.

So it goes on a card. And then the quiet months come, and that goes on the card too. And next summer, he's working to pay off last winter.

Now, let's say Tom does it differently. He looks at his worst three months over the last two years. That's his floor. He takes a wage he can pay himself even in those months. In summer, the extra goes into his slow-month buffer and his tax pot, not his current account. And he sets one if-then plan: if a client pays, then a set share goes straight into tax that day.

In February, he's still paying himself. The same as in July.

Priya and Tom are made up. The maths isn't. Plug your own numbers into the Money Reset Tool and see yours.

So what now? You have three choices.

You can stay the same. Nothing bad's going to happen today. There's no deadline, no consequence. But you're probably going to be having the same conversation with yourself in five years. You might have bigger numbers and less time. How can you tell you stayed the same? You've read three guides like this and done nothing with all this information.

You can half commit. Maybe you do the audit, you find your core belief, you find your script, but nothing really gets written down. And the tell is: you can explain it, but your accounts look the same in six months. You didn't see results straight away, so you gave up.

Or you can commit. One belief, one experiment, one if-then, repeated over thirty, sixty, ninety days, until it becomes boring. That's how you know it's working. Real wealth is boring. It's slow. It's not exciting, but it's real. And the tell is: you've handled something financial without dread.

If they're shooting a rocket to Mars and they're one degree off course, they miss the planet completely. Same goes for your money.

If you want to commit, and you want someone in your corner for it, that's what the 12 weeks are.

>>> APPLY HERE <<<

Inside the Money Story Method

12 weeks, one to one. Behavioural coaching, plus the system actually set up in your accounts. Not a course. Not a community. Not a PDF.

You get:

- 12 one-to-one sessions with me
- Your 90-Day Money Audit, and your real number
- Your money moves, by week three
- Your Money Story Profile and your Behavioural Pattern Report
- Your guardrails and if-then plans
- Your cash flow plan, and three paths forward

£1,000. Or 2 payments of £500, or 3 of £334.

The Eight-Session Promise. If nothing has shifted in your money behaviours by the end of session 8, you get a full refund.

I take 5 coaching places a month.

>>> APPLY HERE <<<

Not ready for coaching? Book a Cash Flow Session instead, and get clarity on your number, and your future number, for the first time ever. 75 minutes, live on screen.

>>> BOOK YOUR CASH FLOW SESSION <<<

What my clients say it's worth

"I never would have got there without you. Never. I can 100% say that." **Alex**

What's it worth? "A grand and a half for the full package." **Alex**

"Probably maybe 1,500." **Hozir**, who paid £300 as a founding client

"2,000 to give a range... You will make that £2,000 back in like no time." **Shambhavi**

"I do believe you've taken me further than anyone else could have in this situation, because there's a programme to it." **Lynton**

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